

4.2.1 Set texts

Students will study three texts: **one** prose, **one** poetry and **one** drama text, at least **one** of which must be written post-2000. They will also respond to an unseen prose extract in the exam.

The paper for this component is open book. Students may take a copy of their set texts into the exam. These texts must **not** be annotated and must **not** contain any additional notes or materials.

Option A: WW1 and its aftermath

Although not an exhaustive list of aspects of WW1 and its aftermath, areas that can usefully be explored include: imperialism and nationalism; recruitment and propaganda; life on the front line; responses on the home front; pacifism; generals and soldiers; slaughter; heroism; peace and memorials; writers in action and writers looking back; the political and social aftermath; different and changing attitudes to the conflict; impact on combatants, non-combatants and subsequent generations as well as its social, political, personal and literary legacies.

Section A: Core set texts

Students study at least **one** of the six core set texts listed below:

Prose

Author	Text
Pat Barker	<i>Regeneration</i>
Sebastian Faulks	<i>Birdsong</i>

Drama

Author	Text
Joan Littlewood	<i>Oh! What a Lovely War</i>
R.C. Sherriff	<i>Journey's End</i>

Poetry

Author	Text
ed. Brian Gardner	<i>Up the Line to Death</i>
ed. Catherine Reilly	<i>Scars Upon My Heart</i>

Section B: Chosen comparative set texts

Students study **two** texts. These texts can be taken from the following list or from the core set text list. Any text from the core set text list used in the Section A response, however, cannot be used in Section B.

Prose

Author	Text
Rebecca West	<i>The Return of the Soldier</i>
Erich Maria Remarque (translated by Brian Murdoch)	<i>All Quiet on the Western Front</i> (Vintage paper back edition)*
Susan Hill	<i>Strange Meeting</i>
Ernest Hemingway	<i>A Farewell to Arms</i>
Robert Graves	<i>Goodbye to All That</i>
Sebastian Barry	<i>A Long, Long Way</i> (post-2000)
Ben Elton	<i>The First Casualty</i> (post-2000)
Pat Barker	<i>Life Class</i> (post-2000)

*The edition of *All Quiet on the Western Front* which must be used is the Vintage paperback edition, translated by Brian Murdoch. We will treat the translated text as Remarque's own words for assessment purposes.

Drama

Author	Text
Peter Whelan	<i>The Accrington Pals</i>
Richard Curtis and Ben Elton	<i>Blackadder Goes Forth</i>

Author	Text
David Haig	<i>My Boy Jack</i>
Ian Hislop and Nick Newman	<i>The Wipers Times</i> (post-2000)

Poetry

Author	Text
ed. George Walter	<i>The Penguin Book of First World War Poetry</i>
ed. Jon Stallworthy	<i>The Oxford Book of War Poetry</i>
ed. Jon Stallworthy	<i>The War Poems of Wilfred Owen</i>

Option B: Modern times: literature from 1945 to the present day

Although not an exhaustive list of aspects of Modern times, areas that can usefully be explored include: wars and the legacy of wars; personal and social identity; changing morality and social structures; gender, class, race and ethnicity; political upheaval and change; resistance and rebellion; imperialism, post-imperialism and nationalism; engagement with the social, political, personal and literary issues which have helped to shape the latter half of the 20th century and the early decades of the 21st century.

Section A: Core set texts

Students study at least **one** of the six core set texts listed below:

Prose

Author	Text
Margaret Atwood	<i>The Handmaid's Tale</i>
Graham Swift	<i>Waterland</i>

Drama

Author	Text
Caryl Churchill	<i>Top Girls</i>
Tennessee Williams	<i>A Streetcar Named Desire</i>

Poetry

Author	Text
Carol Ann Duffy	<i>Feminine Gospels</i> (post-2000)
Owen Sheers	<i>Skirrid Hill</i> (post-2000)

Section B: Chosen comparative set texts

Students study **two** texts. These texts can be taken from the following list or from the core set text list. Any text from the core set text list used in the Section A response, however, cannot be used in Section B.

Prose

Author	Text
Michael Frayn	<i>Spies</i> (post-2000)
Ken Kesey	<i>One Flew Over the Cuckoo's Nest</i>
Arundhati Roy	<i>The God of Small Things</i>
Kathryn Stockett	<i>The Help</i> (post-2000)
Alice Walker	<i>The Color Purple</i>
Jeanette Winterson	<i>Oranges are not the Only Fruit</i>
Richard Yates	<i>Revolutionary Road</i>

Drama

Author	Text
Brian Friel	<i>Translations</i>
Arthur Miller	<i>All My Sons</i>
Timberlake Wertenbaker	<i>Our Country's Good</i>
Tennessee Williams	<i>Cat on a Hot Tin Roof</i>

Poetry

Author	Text
Tony Harrison	<i>Selected Poems</i> 2013 Edition
Seamus Heaney	<i>New Selected Poems</i> 1966–1987
Ted Hughes	<i>Birthday Letters</i>
Sylvia Plath	<i>Ariel</i>

As with all the requirements around genre/dates in this specification, a text can fulfil more than one category. So, for example, *The Help* covers the requirement for a prose text and a text written post-2000.

We do not expect to change texts within the first five years of the specification. However, texts will be reviewed each year starting in September 2017 and we will give at least nine months' notice of any changes prior to first teaching of a two year course. The criteria for changing texts will be where a text becomes unavailable or where we can no longer use it in a question paper. Notice of any change will be communicated via our examination bulletins and aqa.org.uk/english